

In the mother, these risks include having high blood pressure, blood clots, [preeclampsia](#), [polyhydramnios](#), as well as an increased chance of having a Cesarean delivery. For the unborn baby, there is an increased risk of congenital abnormalities, and growth may be too fast or too slow.

Controlling blood-sugar levels reduces the risk of birth defects and stillbirth, or of you having a larger-than-expected baby, which can lead to problems during the birth. The key to a healthy pregnancy and baby when you have diabetes is blood-sugar control, often achieved through dietary changes. You will need special help to adapt your diet to include more carbohydrates and fiber and reduce your intake of fats and sugar.

Some women also require oral medication or, occasionally, insulin injections.